
NOTE

To view the JavaScript error, you must open the browser developer tools. On most browsers, this is done by pressing F12 and then selecting the Console tab.

The Python output of *shortest.py* looks like this:

```
Traceback (most recent call last):
  File "shortest.py", line 4, in <module>
    shortest()
  File "shortest.py", line 2, in shortest
    shortest()
  File "shortest.py", line 2, in shortest
    shortest()
  File "shortest.py", line 2, in shortest
    shortest()
[Previous line repeated 996 more times]
RecursionError: maximum recursion depth exceeded
```

The JavaScript output of *shortest.html* looks like this in the Google Chrome web browser (other browsers will have similar error messages):

```
Uncaught RangeError: Maximum call stack size exceeded
    at shortest (shortest.html:2)
    at shortest (shortest.html:3)
    at shortest (shortest.html:3)
    at shortest (shortest.html:3)
    at shortest (shortest.html:3)
    at shortest (shortest.html:3)
    at shortest (shortest.html:3)
    at shortest (shortest.html:3)
    at shortest (shortest.html:3)
    at shortest (shortest.html:3)
    at shortest (shortest.html:3)
```

This kind of bug is called a *stack overflow*. (This is where the popular website <https://stackoverflow.com> got its name.) The constant function calls with no returns grow the call stack until all the computer's memory allocated for the call stack is used up. To prevent this, the Python and JavaScript interpreters crash the program after a certain limit of function calls that don't return a value.